

good for freshers as they might work to their advantage, but for experienced professionals, it's not that helpful. I have always loved open source, and that prompted me to become an RHCE. Being in the testing domain, people hardly ask me about my certifications until they see that I have the relevant experience in the field."

Ash Sethi, another enthused member of our Facebook community, is quick to react. He feels that, "IT professionals have two tracks in their respective careers—one related to their jobs and another to their interests. IT is so dynamic that you cannot resist the new stuff coming into the market. So you are forced to have an aspiration track too. For example, I am a full time Linux data centre solutions architect but I have an interest in security too, for which I got a couple of security certifications. Also, I completely disagree with Puneet's statement that certifications are helpful only for freshers and not for the experienced. I did my RHCE when I was four years old in the field. Certifications means certifying your skills and experience; they should not be treated as a simple computer course done prior to seeking a job. Being a member of the tech panel of a reputed Indian MNC, I rate experienced people with certifications higher than freshers with certifications—the biggest reason for that is their exposure in the field."

The LUG community's verdict!

While the debate on the importance of certifications continued on our Facebook portal, members of the LUG community flooded us with their interesting comments.

Some members of the LUG community felt that it makes no sense in getting certified as a developer or a programmer, as certifications that cover programming languages and application/Web development frameworks are merely an eye-wash. Chandrashekar Babu, an active member of ILUG, Chennai, quips, "Most candidates who get recruited in this domain are generally interviewed and evaluated by technically competent personnel (preferably a tech-lead or a hired technical consultant) in at least one of the evaluation spins. Certifications might not necessarily help in improving the employability of the candidate in this regard."

"Programmers and developers are best evaluated based on their track records and their problem analysis and solving skills. Having said that, developer/programming certification, if taken seriously by the candidates themselves, would help them in learning the technology well, though it might not guarantee their employability."

Echoing similar thoughts, Karthikeyan A K, another member of ILUG, Chennai, shares, "Personally, I think certification does no good in the open source world. All it boils down to is one's interest. I have seen people flaunting their certifications, but at times, they are junk."

On the other hand, Sankarshan Mukhopadhyay from ILUG Chennai refrains from taking a stand. He writes in jest, "My employer provides a fairly well-known and diverse set of training offerings and it would be difficult for me to keep adding caveats for everything I say. However, consider

Here is the screenshot of the interaction that took place on OSFY's Facebook wall

Open Source For You
March 5

Dear readers, please share your views elaborately on this! How important are certifications related to FOSS when it comes to the job market?

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32 people like this.

Abhinav Krishna not much I think... its mainly ur knowledge... I am a RHCEA and I mentioned it in my resume... but the interviewer dint ask anything abt it... not even the certificate... I guess if u have adequate knowledge of FOSS certification is not at all important.
March 5 at 9:21am via mobile · Like · +2

Open Source For You Abhinav Krishna—That was indeed an insightful comment. Thanks!
March 5 at 9:34am · Like · +2

Ash Sethi certifications do give you an entry to the market, its like keywords/header of ur job profile. The tech panel knows your areas of interest and work and hence it becomes easy for asking questions and scenarios before hiring a candidate.
March 5 at 10:20am via mobile · Like

Anand Vasudevan RHCE is necessary to get in as a Linux sysadmin.
March 5 at 10:25am · Like

Open Source For You Vivek Kumar, Ash Sethi—The comments were really helpful.. thanks
March 5 at 10:25am · Like

Puneet Chhabra Certifications are good for freshers once they are about to start their career as it might aid to their advantage, but for experienced professionals its not that helpful until you are not into that thing like I am into Testing but since I have always loved open source I did RHCE but very few times they ask you about your certification until they see you have relevant experience in that field. cheers...
March 5 at 10:30am · Like · +1

Open Source For You Puneet Chhabra—Good one!
March 5 at 10:40am · Like

Abhisecar Bah I wish I know as much as y'all know.
March 5 at 12:34pm via mobile · Like · +1

Write a comment...

this aspect—employers are commercial entities that provide services against contracts. Contractual obligations require that a specific set of skills be certified by passing an examination. And, hence, there is a reason why employers do place some emphasis on certifications and their ratings."

Certifications are useful in systems and network administration, in general, and in FOSS, there are numerous certification programmes provided and supported by companies. "For instance, there's the RedHat Certified Engineer (RHCE) programme from RedHat Inc (apart from other similar certifications from the same firm), the Ubuntu Certified Professional programme from Canonical Software, the Novell Certified Linux Engineer (NCLE) from Novell Inc, the LPI series of certifications from Linux Professional Institute, etc. Most of the above certifications cater to administrators. This makes